RICHARD MILBURN

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Professional Profile

Manufacturing leader with 21 years' progressive experience at Erwin Hymer Group UK, rising from shop floor operative to Cell Leader of a 29-strong production team across 260 processes. Builds performance by developing people rather than just fixing processes — most notably raising average First Pass Yield from 68.8% to 82.4%, with peak weeks at 96%+. Now targeting Operations, Continuous Improvement, or EHS leadership roles where the same approach applies: clear direction, genuine team ownership, and results delivered through people. Recently completed Lean Six Sigma Yellow and Green Belt and NEBOSH-Verified AI in OSH; now completing the NEBOSH General Certificate.

Career Highlights

- Raised average First Pass Yield from 68.8% to 82.4%, with peak weeks at 96%+ and individual weeks reaching 100%, by giving shop-floor teams direct ownership of quality.
- Grew team skills competency from 36% to 86.6% over two years, achieving 44.2% cross-coverage and removing single points of failure.
- Co-implemented SafetyQube, an EHS (environment, health, and safety) management system; top reporter on site, personally raising 108 of the 324 reports logged from April 2025 to March 2026 (102 near misses and hazards, 6 accident reports), all closed, 33% of all site reports.
- Delivered a 40% reduction in vehicle defects and cut Damaged-in-Production scrap costs to 17.7% under annual budget.
- Designed and led a cross-functional 3x3 training programme, raising operator capability from 79% to 100% across three roles in five months — an approach unmatched elsewhere on site.
- Tracked and drove down equipment downtime across the line, logging roughly 407 hours of breakdown-related losses over a two-year period and targeting the worst offenders through proactive maintenance scheduling and rapid fault escalation.

Work Experience

Team Leader / Cell Leader — Erwin Hymer Group (2015–2026)

Title changed to Cell Leader in 2025 following a contract update; role and team remained the same.

- Led a 29-person production team across 260 processes, owning SQCDP performance, pay evaluation, and disciplinary processes, and partnering with HR, Finance, Sales, R&D and Product Service to align output with build schedules.
- Worked with the Head of Health & Safety to shift the team from compliance to genuine safety ownership — the driver behind the near-miss reporting results above.
- Built and maintained a bay-level Competency Management Matrix mapping all 260 processes, underpinning the skills-competency transformation above.
- Audited SOPs and QVAs to 97.7% critical process coverage; conducted ergonomic (QEC) risk assessments and PUWER-compliant daily machine checks.
- Ran daily reporting and root-cause investigation on production scrap, converting findings into corrective actions and sustained budget improvement.
- Raised 29 of 38 site Design Change Requests (DCRs) (93% close rate), using AutoCAD to draft and validate layout changes, standardising fault capture and driving accountability across shifts.

Key Skills

Leadership & Management

- Coaching & team development
- Performance management & improvement
- Workflow planning
- Safety-focused approach
- Agile prioritisation of workloads

Technical Expertise

- Gas/electrical installation
- Mechanical assembly
- SOP/QVA development

Process Improvement

- Lean manufacturing
- Quality control & RCA
- FPY improvement

Software

- Microsoft Office
- Production/Inventory Systems
- SharePoint
- AutoCAD

Production Key Operative — Erwin Hymer Group (2010–2015)

Promoted from Caravan Production Operative.

- Planned workload distribution to maintain workflow and meet production targets; maintained tools and machinery to minimise downtime.
- Coordinated returned parts and components for efficient processing.

Caravan Production Operative — Erwin Hymer Group (2004–2010)

- Installed electrical systems, PDUs, alarms, battery boxes, lighting, fridges, boilers, pumps, heating controls, and solar systems.
- Performed bonding, preparation, and final quality checks.

Education

Moorside Community Technology College — GCSEs (1991–1996)

Certifications

Completed

- Lean Six Sigma Yellow Belt (CSSC Accredited, July 2026)
- Lean Six Sigma Green Belt (CSSC Accredited, July 2026)
- NEBOSH-Verified AI in Occupational Safety and Health (2026)
- AI Fluency Certification x6 (Anthropic Academy, 2026)
- Leadership and Management Training — Graduate
- Supervisory and Management Training in H&S — Graduate
- IOSH Managing Safely / Working Safely
- NVQ Level 2 Team Leading
- Business Improvement Techniques
- Full UK Driving Licence

In Progress

- NEBOSH General Certificate

Awards & Memberships

- Certificate of Recognition (2023) — 5S SFM Project | Quality Concern Member | Gemba Walk Member | SafetyQube Implementation Team